



Summer at Minnehaha

SUNDAY MORNING SUMMER SCHEDULE

Worship at 9am - inside with organ & choir
Worship at 10:30 am - Outside with band
Faith Formation is on Summer Vacation

SPECIAL SUNDAYS

Yes, every Sunday is special, but mark your calendars for these particular Sundays:

June 9th: Pentecost

We kick-off our summer schedule, and celebrate and bid adieu to our interim choir director, A.P. Hopper; bless our bikes and helmets, and have an all-church potluck picnic following the 10:30 service.

June 30th: Cowboy Sunday

Join us at the 10:30 worship service for our fourth annual Cowboy Sunday, stick around afterwards for an all-church picnic.

August 4th

No service at Minnehaha, join us for worship at Minnehaha Falls at 10:30am.

August 25th

Blessing of the Animals. Bring your pets with you to the 10:30 service for a blessing.

September 1st

Labor Day - One service at 10am

September 8th: Rally Day!

Kick-off the 2019-2020 program year with one service at 10am, followed by an all-church picnic

We look forward to a wonderful summer at Minnehaha & hope you can join us.

www.minnehaha.org
3701 E. 50th Street
Minneapolis MN 55417
612.721.6231

GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

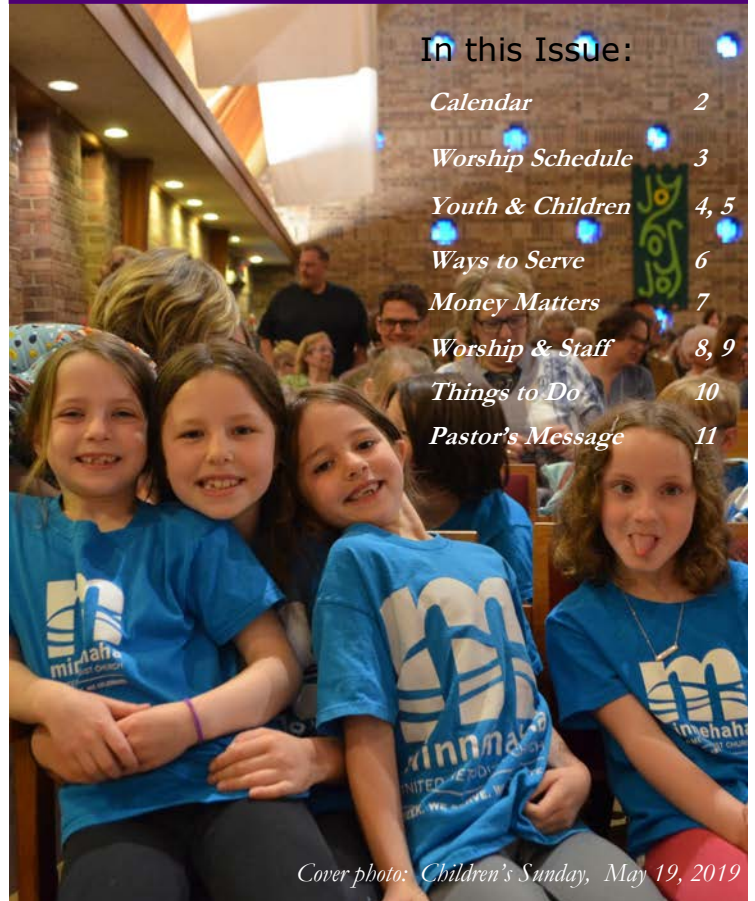
Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

June/July 2019

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Cover photo: Children's Sunday, May 19, 2019

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

Minnehaha Calendar— June & July

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
						1 8a Brighter Minds Music (BMM) 1p BMM Recitals
2 Communion 10a Baccalaureate 11:30a Confirmation 1p BNN Recitals 3p Youth Group 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	3 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p BMM* 6:30p Scouts PPM 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Finance	4 9a Fun & Fitness 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p BMM* 6:30p Toastmasters	5 10a Staff Meeting 5:30p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	6 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fitness 9:30a BMM* 9:30a Minnehaha Playgroup 2:30p BMM* 4:30p BMM*	7 10a Al-Anon 10:30a BNN* 6:30p Scout Crew 1 6:30p RCA	8 8a BMM* 9a Will Party
9 <i>Pentecost</i> 9a All Church Picnic 9a Worship : Organ 10:30a Worship: Band 11:30a Potluck Picnic 1p Rummage Prep 7p SAA	10 Rummage Sale Prep 10a OA 11a Becklund Memorial 1:30p Al-Anon 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1	11 Rummage Sale Prep 9a Fun & Fitness 10:30a Food Shelf	12 Rummage Sale Prep 5:30p Methodicals 7p Children's Council	13 Rummage Sale Prep 9a Fun & Fitness 9:30a Minnehaha Playgroup 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 5p UMW Ladies Night	14 <i>Flag Day</i> Rummage Sale Prep 10a Al-Anon 6:30p Scout Crew 1 6:30p RCA	15 8a Rummage Sale 8a BMM
16 <i>Father's Day</i> 9a Worship: Organ 10:30a Worship: Band 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	17 Music & Drama 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1	18 <i>International Picnic Day</i> Music & Drama 9a Fun & Fitness 10:30a Food Shelf 6:30p Toastmasters	19 VBS Music & Drama 5:30p Methodicals	20 VBS Music & Drama 9a Fun & Fitness 9:30a Minnehaha Playgroup	21 VBS Music & Drama 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA 7p Music & Drama performance	22 <i>Summer Solstice</i> 7a MinneHarvest
23 9a Worship: Organ 10:30a Worship: Band 7p SAA	24 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1	25 9a Fun & Fitness 10:30a Food Shelf 6:30p SPR	26 5:30p Methodicals	27 9a Fun & Fitness 9:30a Minnehaha Playgroup 6:30p Trustees & B+G	28 10a Al-Anon 6:30p Scout Crew 1 6:30p RCA	29
30 <i>Cowboy Sunday</i> 9a Worship: Organ 10:30a Worship: Band 11:30a Potluck Picnic 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	1 July 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p BMM 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1	2 9a Fun & Fitness 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p BMM 6:30p Toastmasters	3 10a Staff Meeting 5:30p Methodicals	4 <i>Independence Day</i> 9a Fun & Fitness 9:30a Minnehaha Playgroup 12p Food Shelf Board	5 10a Al-Anon 5p Wedding Rehearsal 6:30p Scout Crew 1 6:30p RCA	6 Wedding
7 Communion 9a Worship : Organ 10:30a Worship: Band 7p SAA	8 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1	9 9a Fun & Fitness 10:30a Food Shelf	10 5:30p Methodicals 7p Children's Council	11 9a Fun & Fitness 9:30a Minnehaha Playgroup 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq	12 10a Al-Anon 6:30p Scout Crew 1 6:30p RCA	13 9a Boy Scout 1st Aid
14 9a Worship: Organ 10:30a Worship: Band 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	15 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1	16 9a Fun & Fitness 10:30a Food Shelf 6:30p Toastmasters (6:30p Worship Committee	17 5:30p Methodicals	18 9a Fun & Fitness 9:30a Minnehaha Playgroup	19 Newsletter items due 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	20
21 9a Worship : Organ 10:30a Worship: Band 7p SAA	22 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1	23 9a Fun & Fitness 10:30a Food Shelf 6:30p SPR	24 5:30p Methodicals	25 9a Fun & Fitness 9:30a Minnehaha Playgroup 26:30p Trustees & B+G	26 9a Newsletter Collation 10a Al-Anon 6:30p Scout Crew 1 6:30p RCA	27 7a MinneHarvest
28 Urban Bound: Minnehaha Mission 9a Worship : Organ 10:30a Worship :Band 6:30p tbd Togo Church 7p SAA	29 Urban Bound: Minnehaha Mission 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 6:30p tbd Boy Scouts - Troop 1	30 Urban Bound: Minnehaha Mission 9a tbd Fun & Fitness 10:30a Food Shelf	31 Urban Bound: Minnehaha Mission 5:30p Methodicals	Notes: <i>The calendar is accurate, to the best of our knowledge, at the time of printing. Dates and details may change at any time. Please visit www.minnehaha.org to view an up-to-date version of the calendar, and please contact Heather before scheduling any meetings or events. If your event is not on the calendar, you are not guaranteed a meeting space. *Brighter Minds Winter Schedule. Summer will be posted on the online calendar when available.</i>		

Worship in June & July

Summer has arrived, and we are moving into our summer schedule. On June 2, we celebrate our graduates with one service at 10:00. And, on June 9 we begin our summer schedule with 9:00 worship in the sanctuary and 10:30 worship on our side lawn. June 9 is also Pentecost Sunday, so wear red, and we'll have bubbles to blow (see article elsewhere). And, we'll bless bikes and bike helmets at both services. We will then continue our summer schedule through the end of July. Cowboy Sunday will be on June 30 at the 10:30 service. Our ecumenical service at Minnehaha Falls will be on Sunday, August 4 at 10:30 at the pavilion there. See you in worship!

June

- 2nd **“Listening to God: Unexpected Listeners”** Acts 16:16-23
Communion, Graduation Sunday, One Service at 10:00
- 9th **“Listening to God: In All Languages”** Acts 2:1-18
Pentecost (wear red!). We begin our summer worship schedule of 9:00 and 10:30. Blessing of bikes and bike helmets. Picnic to follow!
- 16th **“Using Power for Good”** Luke 7:1-10
One service at 10:00
- 23rd **“Freedom” Luke 8:26-39**
Annual Conference Report
- 30th **“Priorities”** Luke 9:51-62
10:30 Cowboy Sunday with picnic to follow

July

- 7th **“The Power of Words”** Luke 10:1-11, 16-20
Communion
- 14th **“Go and Do Likewise”** Luke 10:25-37
- 21st TBA
- 28th TBA

Save the Date

Future special events at Minnehaha UMC:

- ★ June 30 – Cowboy Sunday at 10:30 service with picnic afterwards
- ★ August 4 – Worship at Minnehaha Falls at 10:30 a.m. with picnic afterwards
- ★ August 25 – Animal Blessing at 10:30 service
- ★ September 1 – One worship service at 10:00 a.m.

Good Things Happen is the newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church, published each month.

The deadline for August is

JULY 19

Contributions may be brought to the office or emailed to:

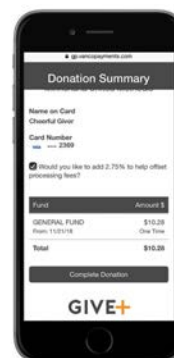
office@minnehaha.org

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Give+ App Makes Giving Easy



Give+ is an easy way to support Minnehaha UMC. Just download the app, set up an account and you can make a one-time gift or set up regular giving in any amount you choose. Thank you!



Download it
from Apple's
App Store or
Google Play

Minnehaha Children, Youth, and Family Ministries

On May 19th, we celebrated the end of the program year: with children, families, and the whole congregation in the morning, and with an end of the year party for youth in the afternoon. We celebrated the connections we've made, the growth we've experienced (individually and as a community), and the incredible awareness that what we each bring to the Minnehaha community and the world can have a profound impact. There is indeed much cause for celebration, but we know as surely that there is still a lot of work for us: work to ensure that we do in fact welcome all, and that peace and justice aren't just ideas but a reality. So, even as we take a step back from our regular pace of programming and embrace a more relaxed pace of life for the summer, we look ahead to what we want to be - how we want our programs and life at Minnehaha to reflect our values and offer our children and youth a place where they are free to explore who they are and how they embrace the work of loving. Have a wonderful, rejuvenating summer - we hope to see you around: in the garden, in worship, at parks, at camp - and we'll be excited to welcome you back to the 2019-2020 Program Year with Rally Day on September 8th.

Jenia Strom

Interim Director of Children, Youth, & Family Ministries



THE TALES OF ROALD DAHL

MUSIC & DRAMA CAMP 2019

MONDAY, JUNE 17 - FRIDAY, JUNE 21ST
FROM 9AM-3PM

PERFORMANCE FRIDAY, JUNE 21ST AT 7PM

Who: Kids/youth are entering 3rd-8th grade

Join us for a wonderful week. Together, under the direction of local actor, director, and teacher Maureen Trepp, we'll take on all aspects of creating a musical production featuring tales by Roald Dahl.

Register today at Minnehaha UMC or by visiting
www.minnehaha.org



Minnehaha UMC's Vacation Bible School 2019

When: Wednesday, June 19th – Friday, June 21st
from 9-11:30am Extended Childcare Available

Who: Children who are 3 (and potty-trained) – 10 years old

Where: Minnehaha United Methodist Church

Cost: \$25/child or \$45/family

Register today at Minnehaha UMC or online at
www.minnehaha.org.

Explore where God's power can take you!
At Minnehaha, we'll spend these three mornings connecting with old friends and new. This space adventure includes amazing science, creative crafts, fun recreation, exciting music, and memorable Bible stories that will help experience God's amazing power.

Glory to God, who is able to do far beyond all that
we could ask or imagine by God's power at work within us
-Ephesians 3:20



Summer

QUESTIONS?



Minnehaha UMC
www.minnehaha.org
612.721.6231
education@minnehaha.org

Sunday, June 2nd: We celebrate all graduates at the 10am service, followed by cake!

Sunday, June 9th: Summer Kick-off at Minnehaha

- Pentecost Sunday: Wear Red!
- Traditional Worship at 9am (Farewell to A.P., our interim choir director)
- Outside Worship at 10:30am - bring your bikes/helmets for a blessing
- Church Potluck Picnic Following
- And, then...gather for our first **Youth Activity of the Summer: Adventure to Jordan MN** to visit MN's Largest Candy Store. We'll leave right after the all-church picnic - at noon, and return to Minnehaha for pick up by 2:45pm.

Starting June 16th, July, join us on Sunday training runs, working towards running a 5K. Those interested can join Minnehaha members at the Aquatennial Run on July 24th.

June 17-21: Music & Drama Camp & June 19-21: VBS - We're still looking for volunteers for VBS. Youth who've completed 7th grade can sign up to help with VBS.

July 28-30: Minnehaha Urban Bound, for those who've completed 8th-12th grade

August 15th: All Youth Activity: Serving at Feed My Starving Children from 11:30-2:30pm

Food Ministries

MUMC has a number of food ministries, and we support two of them financially. MinneHarvest is a monthly free food giveaway, and our Food Shelf is a weekly food shelf for residents in our neighborhood, supported by us, Lake Nokomis Lutheran, and St. James Episcopal on the Parkway. Both of these ministries need regular financial support in order for them to continue to provide food to those in need. Please consider making a regular contribution to one or both of these ministries; you can use the handy envelopes provided in the pews, you can write a check and indicate either MinneHarvest or Food Shelf on the memo line, or you can use our Give+ App and indicate either MinneHarvest or Food Shelf from the options.

If you would like to volunteer your time, the Food Shelf and MinneHarvest have plenty of spaces for volunteers. We can also use volunteers for two of our other food ministries, Meals on Wheels and serving a meal at Simpson Housing Services. You can contact Rachel Larson to volunteer for Meals on Wheels, and Maureen Trepp for the next SHS meal date.

Serving Homeless

We're serving dinner at Simpson on Wed. June 26 and we need you! I (Maureen) will be out of town so cannot guarantee a carpool but hopefully someone will be picking up food and folks to help at church on that date about 5:15 or you can meet us at Simpson Shelter on 28th St. and 1st Ave. We work from 5:45 to about 8:30. I would also love to have someone volunteer to cook on that date; food is paid for by UMW funds. Please let me know how you will help! Maureen at 612-387-2520

Families Moving Forward will again be hosting homeless families at Lake Nokomis Lutheran during the week of Aug. 4-10. If you are interested in volunteering for this (they will need hosts, cooks, set-up folks, people to play with kids and more) you can find out more at lakenokomischurch.org and click on Families Moving Forward. Please consider



When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC in rooms 202 and 204. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us; join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.



Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9:30-11:30am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

MinneHarvest

Our free food give-away once a month (on the fourth Saturday of the month) is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. Please join us in June and July on Saturday, June 22 and Saturday, July 27. You can volunteer anytime between 6:30 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up at 6:30, unload the trucks starting at 7, serve the food at 9:00, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us for all or any portion of that time, and bring a friend! Unless it is raining, we unload and distribute food outside at the front of the church during the summer, and there is generally a lot of great produce!

Apportionments

Apportionments are the amount of money each United Methodist congregation is asked to pay to its Annual Conference to help share in the costs of the larger denomination. Money goes to pay the salaries and benefits of people who work at the conference office, it funds things like our camping program and mission trips, and then each Annual Conference is apportioned a certain amount to pay for the larger, global church. As you can imagine, the topic of apportionments has been hot since the February special General Conference. After asking lots of questions, here is what we are doing at Minnehaha – we are paying our apportionments. And, here's why:

We designated our apportionments to be kept in Minnesota, so they fund ministries here.

We still benefit from many conference level programs and staff persons.

There is still a chance that our entire Annual Conference will move into whatever new denomination forms together. Paying our apportionments keeps that structure healthy and able to negotiate that transition.

The current rule if we want to leave the denomination is that we have to be current on our last two years of apportionments, so if we don't pay them now, we will just have to pay them later. Paying them now lets us all use them. Paying them as we leave simply hands our money over to the people we are trying to protest against.

It's a complex issues, and we have had many conversations about this at both the Finance Committee and at Church Council. If you have more questions, please feel free to talk to anyone on the Finance Committee, or talk to Becky directly.

Will Party –

Saturday, June 8 @ 9:00 am

On Saturday, June 8, starting at 9:00 am with a continental breakfast, Minnehaha UMC will host a "Will Party" event. All are invited to attend, young and old.

This "Will Party" will provide an opportunity for those who wish to start or revise a will to meet with an attorney. Steve Otto of Otto Law (www.ottoesq.com), a Twin Cities law firm focusing on estate planning/probate administration and business law, will be at the meeting to talk about wills, answer your questions, and to meet one-on-one to discuss your estate planning needs. (There is no charge for this initial consultation.) If you would like to have a will drawn up or do other estate planning, you can set up a follow-up meeting.

Childcare will also be provided upon request. RSVP's not necessary but appreciated so we know about how many will be attending. Questions regarding this event and RSVP's may be directed to Kim Kanuit at kanuitkk@q.com or call/text 612-860-0256. Thank you.



Rummage Sale **Minnehaha UMC**

joining with NENA on
Annual Garage Sale Day!
Saturday, June 16, 2018
8:00am-4:00pm!

Beginning, Tue, May 28th, you can bring items to the stage in the Fellowship Hall through Wed, Jun 12th

- Housewares / Linens
- Tools / Sporting Equipment
- Toys / Books / Camping Gear
- Children's Clothing & Shoes

Volunteers needed Jun 9-15! Please see Annette Meier or Jenny Ammerman to sign up!



SUNDAY, JUNE 30TH

Minnehaha's Cowboy Sunday

Join us for our fourth annual Cowboy Sunday
& All-Church Grill Out in the Garden

When: Sunday, 30th July at second service – 10:30am
following worship, stay for lunch & Lawn Games

We'll grill out – hot dogs & cowboy beans
& people should bring salads or desserts to share

Hope to see y'all here!

Jenia Strom Hired to Children and Youth Position

The Staff Parish Relations Committee is delighted to announce that we have hired Jenia Strom to the position of Director of Programming for Children, Youth and Their Families, effective immediately.

Wait, you are thinking, I thought she already had that position? And, she did, but on an interim basis. Last year in August, SPR asked Jenia to take on this new role as an interim until the end of May as we evaluated the impact of combining our children and youth programming into one staff role. This spring, we decided that the combined position was meeting many of the needs expressed by parents and leadership, so we posted the position as a permanent hire. Jenia applied for the permanent position, and we hired her, effective immediately. We are delighted that she is taking on the work she has already been doing, and we are also appreciative of the many adults who are volunteering with both our children and our youth which has enriched our programming and widened the connections that our children and youth have with the rest of the congregation.

Monthly Communion at Nokomis Square

A brief service of communion is offered at Nokomis Square on the second Thursday of this month. All are welcome to join us on June 13 & July 11 at 1:00 p.m.

Bikes, Pentecost, Picnic!

It all happens on June 9!

Summer schedule begins, 9:00 service inside,
10:30 service outside.

It's Pentecost, so wear red to celebrate the
flames of the Holy Spirit

We're blessing bikes and bike helmets, so bring
yours.

It is A.P. Hopper's last Sunday as our Interim
Choir Director, so stay for a little party
following the 9:00 service.

Potluck picnic following the 10:30 service in the
lawn – bring a dish to share

If it rains (which it won't), then the 10:30 worship
and picnic will be held in the Fellowship Hall. We'll
still bless bikes and bike helmets.

Help with Sound & Projection

We need a few more adults who are willing to be trained in on our sound system and our projection during worship services. Mike Becklund and Kevin McCanney do an awesome job at the first and second services, respectively, but they would like to have a cadre of adults who can work with them on a regular basis. With Don Mathews gone for his job 2 out of 3 Sundays, we have a bit of a hole back at the sound and projection board. Don has trained in a number of youth on projection, and couple more on sound, but an extra adult each week would also be appreciated. Don is willing to train on sound and/or projection for anyone interested. The first service is simpler for the sound needs, and the second service is more complex with the band. Projection is the same for both services, but we don't use it for the second service in the summer when we are outside.

You don't need to be able to cover every week, but we'd like a regular rotation of folks. If you are interested, please talk to Becky or to Don Mathews. Thank you!!



Introducing Alex Rack, our new Choir Director

Hello! My name is Alex Rack and I'm very excited to be your new choir director. I grew up in Pennsylvania, came to Minnesota for school, and have been living here ever since. I'm currently enrolled at the University of Minnesota finishing my masters in choral conducting. Before that I worked as the assistant choir director at Macalester College where I also studied music and psychology. In addition to singing in and conducting choirs, I also play keyboard in a band with my friends, and I love to cook, swim and bike. Can't wait to meet, and make music with you!

Wear Red!

Pentecost is the celebration of the birthday of the church, and it is traditional to wear red that day (red symbolizes the flames of the Holy Spirit). This year, we will celebrate Pentecost on June 9, so come and wear some red!

Cowboy Sunday and Outdoor Potluck

Get your cowboy on for our fourth annual Cowboy Sunday on June 30 at the 10:30 service. The theme will be "home." You can wear your boots, bandanas, hats, or whatever you feel like wearing. We'll have a fire, and the worship service will have a more participatory feel with cowboys chewing the fat for the sermon. Afterwards, we'll all have lunch outside. Bring a dish to share and something to put on the grill.

Pride Parade

June is the month for celebrating LGBTQ Pride all over the nation, and the parade and festival in the Twin Cities will be Saturday and Sunday, June 22-23. The Festival is held at Loring Park, and you can go there anytime from 10-10 on Saturday or 10-6 on Sunday. You'll find concerts, food vendors, booths for companies and organizations, and so much more. Their webpage, TCPride.org will give you all the information. If you go, look for the Reconciling Congregations booth. The Parade is on Sunday and kicks off at 11:00 a.m. The United Methodist Reconciling Congregations have a walking contingent and members of reconciling congregations are welcome to join in however they can. The units line up on 3rd Street, facing Hennepin Ave. and the parade goes down 2nd Avenue this year (a change due to construction on Hennepin Avenue) until it reaches Loring Park. You can find our unit number (which will aid in finding our group more quickly) on the pride web page a couple days prior to the parade. If you did not order the Inclusive Methodist T-shirt, there will be a few extras at the line-up on the parade route for sale. Otherwise, we recommend wearing your Minnehaha T-shirt and bringing some Hershey's kisses to hand out to people along the parade route.



Run With Us

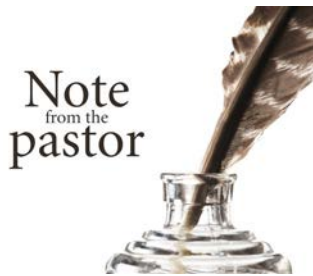
Looking for a way to keep yourself and your kids/youth active this spring and summer? Feel like checking "Ran a 5K down Hennepin Avenue" off the bucket list?

Come run with us!

Starting Sunday June 16th, we'll meet at the beach on the east side of Lake Nokomis at noon on Sundays through July 21st. We'll stretch as a group then you can walk, jog, or run around Lake Nokomis at your own pace, solo or with friends as you choose for the next hour or so. Children and youth must have an adult (18+) accompany them. It will be a fun way to keep each other motivated!

Once you've honed your running or walking form, come join your Minnehaha family and friends at the Torchlight 5K on July 24th at 7:30 pm in downtown Minneapolis. The race is part of the Minneapolis Aquatennial and more information and pricing is available at www.torchlight5K.com. When registering, put "Minnehaha church" as the group/team name. Runners are responsible for their own registration and race fee and children and youth will also need an adult with them.

Email Ashley Smit at Ashley.e.smit@gmail.com if you are interested in participating in the 5K and you will be emailed further info.



Getting Together

Summer seems to be the time for get-togethers. Picnics, trips to visit relatives, trips with relatives, gatherings at the beach or the park or the playground. For many of us, summer has a different rhythm than the rest of the year. I don't have school-age children (actually, I don't have any children . . .), but even I refer to "the school year" and summer. We take a break from some things in the summer, but engage in other activities. And, truth be told, lots of those activities pull us away from church programming and from worship. It's why we stop our Wednesday night rehearsals, why children and youth programming focuses on big events (like camp or mission trips) instead of weekly gatherings. Even the choir take a break from Wednesday night rehearsals in the summer. I welcome all of it. The gathering together in different ways, the change in focus, the suspension of some programs so we can focus on others. But I want to make a case for church in the midst of summer. Being part of a community is important to both being human and to being a Christian. We can certainly sense God all on our own, but there is a different way of experiencing God that happens in a faith community. I hear someone else's expression, I check out my own thoughts ("does this seem weird to you? I feel like God is calling me to . . ."), I see a broader God in community than I do on my own. And community happens only through intentional care. Being part of a community requires action on my part. I can't check out for awhile and then come back, expecting everything to be the same. I need to participate in order to add my unique perspective. And, the more I participate, the more I grow with my community.

So, in short, Minnehaha isn't the same without you. And you aren't the same without Minnehaha. Amidst all your community time this summer, continue to participate in this community as well. We will all be the richer for it.

In Joy,
Becky





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6&7/19

